

Name: _____

A Level Mathematics : Pure Mathematics

Topic 5 :Trigonometry - Trigonometric problem-solving

Date:

Time:

Total marks available:

Total marks achieved: _____

© 2025 Exam Papers Practice. All Rights Reserved

Questions

Q1.

The depth of water, D metres, in a harbour on a particular day is modelled by the formula

$$D = 5 + 2 \sin(30t)^\circ \quad 0 \leq t < 24$$

where t is the number of hours after midnight.

A boat enters the harbour at 6:30 am and it takes 2 hours to load its cargo.

The boat requires the depth of water to be at least 3.8 metres before it can leave the harbour.

(a) Find the depth of the water in the harbour when the boat enters the harbour.

(1)

(b) Find, to the nearest minute, the earliest time the boat can leave the harbour.

(Solutions based entirely on graphical or numerical methods are not acceptable.)

(4)

(Total for question = 5 marks)

Q2.

In this question you must show all stages of your working.

Solutions relying entirely on calculator technology are not acceptable.

(a) Show that

$$\cos 3A \equiv 4\cos^3 A - 3\cos A$$

(4)

(b) Hence solve, for $-90^\circ \leq x \leq 180^\circ$, the equation

$$1 - \cos 3x = \sin^2 x$$

(4)

(Total for question = 8 marks)

Q3.

(a) Express $10 \cos \theta - 3 \sin \theta$ in the form $R \cos (\theta + \alpha)$, where $R > 0$ and $0 < \alpha < 90^\circ$

Give the exact value of R and give the value of α , in degrees, to 2 decimal places.

(3)

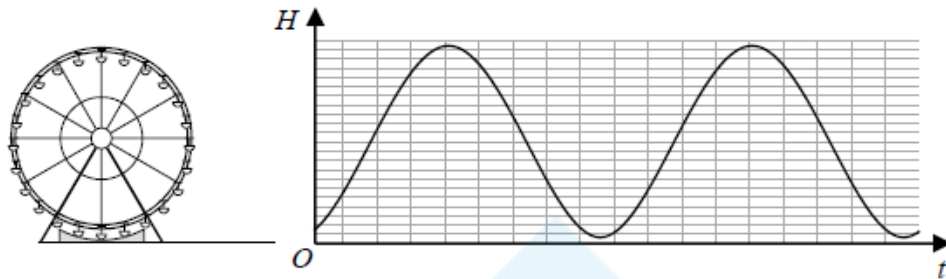


Figure 3

The height above the ground, H metres, of a passenger on a Ferris wheel t minutes after the wheel starts turning, is modelled by the equation

$$H = \alpha - 10 \cos (80 t)^\circ + 3 \sin (80 t)^\circ$$

where α is a constant.

Figure 3 shows the graph of H against t for two complete cycles of the wheel.

Given that the initial height of the passenger above the ground is 1 metre,

- (b) (i) find a complete equation for the model,
 (ii) hence find the maximum height of the passenger above the ground.

(2)

(c) Find the time taken, to the nearest second, for the passenger to reach the maximum height on the second cycle.

(Solutions based entirely on graphical or numerical methods are not acceptable.)

(3)

It is decided that, to increase profits, the speed of the wheel is to be increased.

(d) How would you adapt the equation of the model to reflect this increase in speed?

(1)

(Total for question = 9 marks)

Q4.

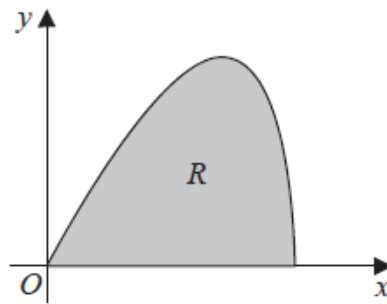


Figure 3

The curve shown in Figure 3 has parametric equations

$$x = 6 \sin t \quad y = 5 \sin 2t \quad 0 \leq t \leq \frac{\pi}{2}$$

The region R , shown shaded in Figure 3, is bounded by the curve and the x -axis.

(a) (i) Show that the area of R is given by $\int_0^{\frac{\pi}{2}} 60 \sin t \cos^2 t \, dt$ (3)

(ii) Hence show, by algebraic integration, that the area of R is exactly 20 (3)

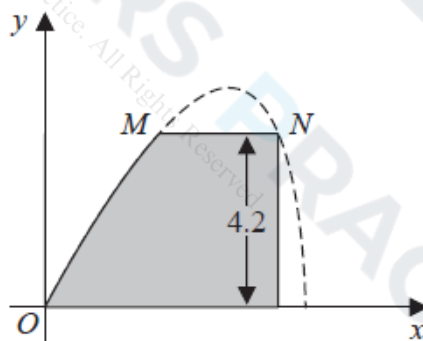


Figure 4

Part of the curve is used to model the profile of a small dam, shown shaded in Figure 4. Using the model and given that

- x and y are in metres
- the vertical wall of the dam is 4.2 metres high
- there is a horizontal walkway of width MN along the top of the dam

(b) calculate the width of the walkway.

(5)

(Total for question = 11 marks)

Q5.

(a) Express $\sin x + 2 \cos x$ in the form $R \sin(x + \alpha)$ where R and α are constants, $R > 0$

and $0 < \alpha < \frac{\pi}{2}$

Give the exact value of R and give the value of α in radians to 3 decimal places.

(3)

The temperature, θ °C, inside a room on a given day is modelled by the equation

$$\theta = 5 + \sin\left(\frac{\pi t}{12} - 3\right) + 2 \cos\left(\frac{\pi t}{12} - 3\right) \quad 0 \leq t < 24$$

where t is the number of hours after midnight.

Using the equation of the model and your answer to part (a),

(b) deduce the maximum temperature of the room during this day,

(1)

(c) find the time of day when the maximum temperature occurs, giving your answer to the nearest minute.

(3)

(Total for question = 7 marks)